



Cherry Blossom

CHALLENGE

2025

17th - 27th April 2025

**DARE
TO
TREK**

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Welcome!

Thank you and congratulations for signing up to the Islamic Relief Cherry Blossom Challenge. This guide will provide you with everything you will need to prepare for the challenge, including an itinerary and checklist.

On this tough 10-day challenge, you will trek 946km across Hunza Valley to Skardu Valley starting at Islamabad. Both Valleys are located in Gilgit-Baltistan, a region of breathtaking nature and boasting some of the most serene scenery you'll ever see. Home to some of the largest mountains in the world, it is the perfect playground for adventurous souls.

As well as taking part in the challenge, you will have the chance to meet and spend time with fellow challengers - saving lives and making friends for life!

As you train and prepare for this adventure of a lifetime, you will fundraise £2,000 to help rebuild Pakistan after the devastating floods of 2022! Our fundraising team are here to help you reach your fundraising goal. You are not alone in this, we know you can do it and we're to help!

We can't wait to take on this adventure with you!

Day 1

17th April Arrival in Islamabad

You will fly into Islamabad International Airport where our team will meet you.

The team will take you to the hotel after checkin which is at 11am. You will have the rest of the day to shake off any jet lag. If you're an intrepid explorer who believes jet lag is for the weak, you will be free to check out the city at your leisure.

We will bring everyone together in the evening for an initial welcome and briefing.

Hotel: Roomy Hotel



Day 2

18th April Visit Islamic Relief Projects

You will be introduced to the Islamic Relief team based in our Pakistan Head Office in Islamabad.

You will have the opportunity to speak to the staff about their work and learn about the projects we deliver in Pakistan.

We will also take you out to see some of our active projects in Rawalpindi, allowing you to meet some of our rightsholders and hear how your beautiful efforts impact their lives.

The evening will be spent enjoying the city view of Islamabad from Monal Restaurant in the hills, overlooking the city.

Hotel: Roomy Hotel Islamabad

Please note that this itinerary is subject to change.

Day 3

19th April Islamabad to Chilas

Today we begin our journey to the spectacular landscape of Northern Pakistan!

We won't lie to you, the day begins with an early start with an eleven-hour **drive** between Islamabad and Chilas with a stop for lunch in Besham.

This gives you plenty of time to get to know those you are on this journey with and watch the changing landscape become more dramatic as you continue north.

Hotel: Shangrila Hotel Chilas



20th April Chilas to Hunza Valley

Day 4

Another day of driving North but this time you'll be stopping along the way to take in some of the iconic spots of the area including Nanga Parbat View Point and Junction Point (one the world's highest mountain ranges!)

The scenes will be immaculate and you'll be wishing you had cleared more space in your camera memory!

Hotel: Best Western Hotel

Please note that this itinerary is subject to change.



Day 5

21st April Chill & Thrill Day!

Start with a visit to the historic Altit Fort, where you can enjoy breathtaking mountain views. Then, head to the lively Hunza Market to shop for local treasures and treat yourself to delicious street food.

Next, experience the thrill of crossing the legendary Husaini Bridge and capture stunning photos of the iconic Passu Cones.

After an action-packed day, relax and unwind as you make your way back to the hotel to reflect on all the unforgettable moments!

22nd April Trek to Passu Glacier

On this day, you'll head to the stunning Borith Lake, where the adventure begins with a 4-hour hike to the magnificent Passu Glacier.

Afterward, you'll return to Borith Lake and relax for the night at Luzus Hunza, ready for a restful sleep and another exciting day ahead!



Day 6

Please note that this itinerary is subject to change.

Day 7

23rd April Travel to Skardu

Get ready for an exciting 6-hour journey to Skardu, where you'll visit the breathtaking Shagrila Lake and Uper Kachura Lake, soaking in the stunning views. After a day full of adventure!

You will spend the night in Skardu
Hotel: Green Pak Resort



24th April Shigar Valley Tour

Day 8

After enjoying a hearty breakfast to kickstart your day, you'll set off on a scenic 1-hour trek to the charming organic village in Skardu, passing through the fascinating cold desert landscape.

After a day full of exploration and adventure, you'll head back to Skardu to relax and unwind for the night
Hotel: Green Pak Resort

Please note that this itinerary is subject to change.

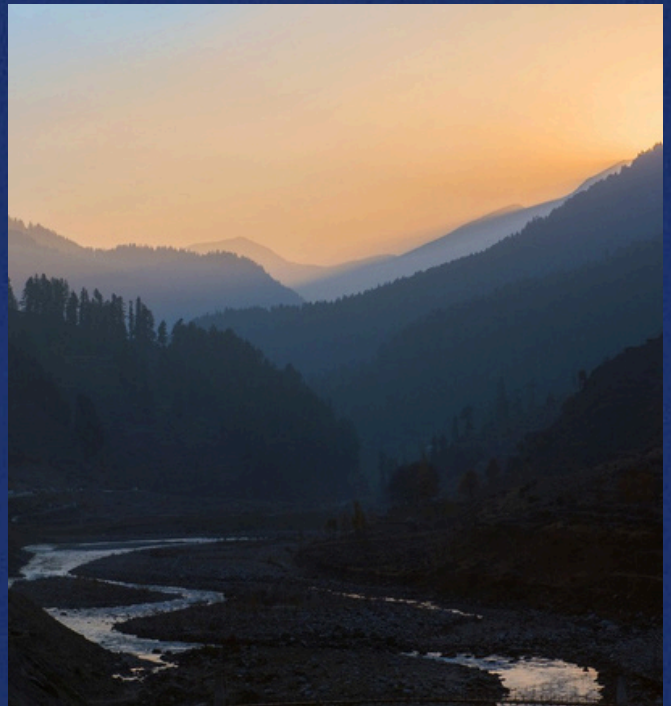
25th April

Back to Islamabad

Day 9

On this day you will depart for Skardu and catch a flight to Islamabad. This is a chance for you to reflect on your amazing trip as well as get some rest!

You will spend the night in Islamabad.



26th April

A bittersweet goodbye

There's never a right time to say goodbye, however, you'll have made lasting friendships on this adventure of a lifetime.

After being transferred to the airport, you will eventually arrive back in the UK to return to normality - likely talking about Northern Pakistan to anyone who will listen!

Day 10

Please note that this itinerary is subject to change.

Training



There are elements of this challenge that will likely be new to your body.

On the trekking days of this challenge, you will be walking 6-7 hours of walking. You will also be taking part in other activities. If you haven't prepared properly, you will be sore all over!



So how do you train for them?

- Walk regularly, ideally on hilly terrain. If there are no hills near you, you can use your staircase.
- Whilst training, wear all the gear you'll be trekking in so to get used to it all - boots, socks, waterproof gear, backpack - the whole nine yards!
- If you've bought new boots, your number one priority should be to break them in - no one wants to deal with pesky blisters on the day of the hike!
- Start off taking regular one-hour walks during the week and gradually move to 4-5 hour long walks on the weekends to build up your stamina.
- Be sure to push yourself - work your lungs and don't just amble along! Your heart and breathing rates should increase 3-6 times a week for 30-60 minutes each time.



Support our Fundraising

Water for Life

By taking on this challenge, you're helping to provide water to vulnerable communities around the world

785 million people around the world do not have access to clean water, a basic human right? With global challenges like climate change, the ongoing impact of COVID-19, and numerous conflicts affecting millions, the need for safe, clean water has never been more pressing. Access to clean water is crucial for health, education, and economic development, yet so many communities are left without it.

Islamic Relief is making a difference by working in over 40 countries to provide sustainable and reliable sources of water, helping ensure that vulnerable communities have access to this essential resource. By participating in this fundraising campaign, you're playing a vital role in making that happen. Every donation you raise will directly contribute to providing life-saving water solutions to those who need it most.

The funds you help raise will not only provide clean water but will also bring hope and dignity to countless families struggling to survive. Together, we can make a meaningful impact and create a brighter, healthier future for those facing unimaginable hardships.

Let's work together to raise awareness, funds, and help ensure clean water for all!

The gift of water saves lives Allah (SWT) says in the Quran And whosoever saves one [a life] it is as if he has saved all of mankind. (Quran 5:32)



Fundraising Tips

Daunted by the prospect? Don't be, it's a lot easier than it seems. You're not the first and certainly will not be the last to take on such a challenge. Embrace it for all it's worth. From the time that you sign up for the adventure to the time that you depart you will not only be preparing yourself for the adventure of a lifetime but you will be expanding your skills by holding various fundraisers to help you meet your target amount. It's important to break it into smaller, more manageable targets. Fundraising can be easy and enjoyable. And it really is all down to you. It's a huge challenge to raise such an amount of money but remember it is more than achievable. Many challengers over the years have multiplied their fundraising targets! Here we have outlined a few ideas to help you to raise the target amount. If you have any questions please let us know and if you need any additional materials Islamic Relief will be happy to provide them.

E-Fundraising

The internet can, if used well, be an amazing fundraising tool for you. You should already have your own fundraising page set up online.

Make It Personal

Make your page as compelling as possible by adding your own photograph and text. Make sure your page communicates the reason you have chosen to raise money, and why you believe Islamic Relief deserves support. Be creative!

Family & Friends 1st

Before sending an email to your entire address book, ask your closest friends and family to donate first. An empty page can be a little intimidating, so do make sure to capture a couple of donations before contacting your entire list of potential sponsors. People tend to match the amounts already listed on the page, so target your most generous supporters first!

Social Media

This is an excellent way of keeping friends updated and asking friends to pass on your fundraising page. You can link your JustGiving page to your facebook, and other social media accounts to expose your page to more people. You can also add it to your stories on instagram through a link or any other social media you use regularly. Go live before your challenge as you prepare to create more traction to your page.



Tell Everyone you Know

Email your family, friends and colleagues with a link to your page, but don't forget other groups of potential supporters: former colleagues, old school and college friends, and Facebook/Instagram friends you may be surprised how many would like to sponsor you. Encourage them all to pass on the message to anyone else that might support Islamic Relief's work. You can also contact your work managers and see if your company will match your donations as many companies may offer this incentive.

Contact your Local Media

local paper, or an appeal for sponsorship on your local radio station, can yield amazing results. With online fundraising, attracting sponsorship couldn't be easier — readers and listeners can simply visit your page and sponsor you direct.

“Every act of goodness is charity”

Prophet Muhammad [SAW]

Kit List

This is a suggested packing list of some items needed for this adventure.

Clothing should be casual and hard-wearing; easy to wash field clothes are best for most of the days. It is best to pack several thinner layers rather than one thick layer.

It is also best not to pack more items than what you actually need as we will be covering large distances in buses and you don't want to be squashed up with your luggage!



Track Pants



Waterproof
Trousers



Waterproof
Jacket



Thermals



Micro-fleece



T-shirt



Cap/Hat



Boots



Trainers



Slippers



Socks



Gloves



Backpack



Reusable
Bottle



Torch



Sunglasses



Medicine



First Aid Kit



Sunscreen



Insect
Repellent



Hand
Santisier



Wipes



Sewing Kit



Passport



Insurance
Certificate

Additional Information

Service Inclusion

Travel Dates:

17th - 27th April

Destination:

Pakistan

What is included:



- English Speaking Travel Guide
- Meals (Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner)
- Daily Evening Tea/Green Tea
- All transfers to cities and towns
- Fuel Expenses, Toll & Parking Fees
- 4*4 Vehicle (where required)
- Mineral Water in Vehicles
- Accommodation
- Entry Tickets
- Invitation Letter & Visa Assistance
- Basic First Aid
- River Rafting Equipment
- Rock Climbing Equipment
- Porters for camping equipment

Hotels:

- Islamabad: Roomy Hotel
- Chilas: Shangrila Hotel Chilas
- Hunza: Best Western Hotel
- Skardu: Green Pak Resort

What is NOT included:



- Flights
- Travel Insurance
- Food outside of arranged meals
- Porters for personal luggage participants
- Flight Cancellations
- Laundry
- Room Service
- Tips
- Any additional excursions

Thank you!

Thank you for your commitment, your time, and your heart in this important Water for Life mission.

Your support is often the gift of life itself and we take special care to reach those who are most at risk, which is only possible with your support. We've seen with our own eyes how their lives have been uplifted and transformed by what you give.

We look forward to seeing you in Pakistan this April!

